



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy of Orlando
School Website: <https://chestertonorlando.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Chesterton Academy of Orlando (Winter Park, FL) presents a robust classical-Catholic educational model, with clear emphasis on the Great Books, Socratic discourse, and formation of virtue within a Catholic framework. Public materials depict a deliberately faith-centered curriculum in which theology, philosophy, and literature are woven into all subjects; community and family engagement are central, and the school emphasizes a life-oriented rather than career-focused aim for education. Taken together, the six-category rubric yields a predominantly CLASSICAL rating across RMF, Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community. The school shows explicit commitments to truth, goodness, and beauty; formation of character through virtue; a Great Books/liberal-arts curriculum; Socratic pedagogy and rhetoric; a living, faithful faculty; and active parental partnership and community involvement.

In brief: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL, with explicit Catholic identity, Biblical literacy, catechesis, liturgical practice, and daily prayer culture. - Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL, emphasizing formation, virtue, wisdom, and a life-oriented telos rather than mere job-prep or credentialing. - Curriculum: CLASSICAL, centering on Great Books, liberal arts, and a Great Conversation orientation; history integrated through a classical lens; emphasis on wonder. - Pedagogy: CLASSICAL, with contemplative/restful elements, strong Socratic seminars, and explicit rhetoric training. - Faculty: CLASSICAL, featuring faithful, mentoring teachers and a living-curriculum approach. - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL, with formal partnership with families and active parental involvement in campus culture and governance.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials consistently present Chesterton Academy of Orlando as “a classical high school, grounded in the Catholic faith,” with the mission to lead students toward truth, goodness, and beauty, culminating in a love for God. This framing appears across multiple pages, e.g., “Chesterton Academy of Orlando is a classical high school, grounded in the Catholic faith. Our mission is to help students recognize the true, imitate the good, and adore the beautiful, falling in love with the source of it all—God himself.”
- The Catholic identity is explicit: “Catholic Identity” section notes that all classes point to the Incarnation, and students study the Bible, Catechism of the Catholic Church, and papal documents; every teacher and student is described in Catholic terms.
- Daily liturgical practices and faith integration are mentioned (e.g., Morning Prayer, Closing Prayer; Catholic theology/philosophy coursework).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Catholic faith; Bible; Catechism; Theology; Prayer; Liturgical/Feast-day practice; Incarnation; Catholic culture.

- Negative keywords present: None evident in public materials.
- Quantitative note: Positive keywords observed in public materials (roughly 6–7 distinct cues across pages); Negative keywords: 0.
- Why this rating
- The materials foreground a Catholic-metaphysical frame, explicit liturgical-prayer practices, and a theology/philosophy core across disciplines. The frequency and prominence of these terms strongly align with CLASSICAL expectations in the RMF category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- School purpose centers on formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom, not merely job-readiness: the public messaging emphasizes formation for life, the true/good/beautiful telos, and love of truth and God. For example, the mission frames formation as a pathway to recognize the true, imitate the good, and adore the beautiful, in love with God.
- Explicit statements align with formation over information: “The goal of high school is preparing students for life by discerning God’s will and helping them get to heaven,” and “The goal of high school is not college prep.” These lines anchor the formation telos rather than workforce-centric aims.
- Public materials tie the educational aim to transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and human flourishing within a Christian framework.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; wisdom; truth/goodness/beauty; telos; contemplation/scholé; human flourishing.
- Negative keywords present: none explicitly (the materials reject a narrow “workforce prep” framing and emphasize formation).
- Quantitative note: Positive keywords observed in public materials (roughly 5–6 distinct cues); Negative keywords observed: 0.
- Why this rating
- The school’s stated aims consistently privilege formation, virtue, wisdom, and a teleological vision of education grounded in truth and beauty, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for this category.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Great Books orientation and liberal arts core are explicit: materials describe a classical curriculum based around the Great Books, with references to Homer, Augustine, Dante, Shakespeare, and Aquinas; courses are framed as part of a Great Conversation.
- History within a classical frame and emphasis on a liberal-arts backbone appear (e.g., references to logic, rhetoric, grammar, as part of the classical education, plus emphasis on the Great Conversation).
- The curriculum integrates theology/philosophy across all disciplines; students undertake four years of Catholic theology and four years of Catholic philosophy, alongside Bible and Catechism study.
- References to the Great Books and the continuation of the “Great Conversation” appear repeatedly; the curriculum is described as “classical” with emphasis on reading great works and engaging in dialogue.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Great Books; Great Conversation; liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric); history (within classical framing); reading of primary classics (Homer, Augustine, Dante, Shakespeare, Aquinas); formation via the curriculum.
- Negative keywords present: none evident.
- Quantitative note: Positive keywords observed: ~6–7 distinct cues; Negative keywords: 0.
- Why this rating
- The curriculum centers on liberal-arts pedagogy, classic literature and philosophy, and a Great Books framework consistent with classical education ideals.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence

- Socratic pedagogy is explicitly described: “The Great Books in the Socratic style,” and discussions are conducted face-to-face rather than lecturing. This is a core classical method.
- The pedagogy emphasizes memory, recitation, and engagement (e.g., “sing in the choir, act on the stage, give speeches, engage in debate” and the memory/development through repetition and singing).
- There is a stated balance of contemplative/restful elements and rigorous discussion, reflecting scholastic contemplation alongside rigorous inquiry in upper grades (Socratic discourse, rhetoric training).
- Lower-school activities include singing and communal practices, aligning with a memory-based, traditional pedagogy common in classical education.
- Technology is minimized to preserve focus on books, discussion, and writing, supporting a contemplative/classical pedagogy rather than screen-based instruction.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Socratic/seminar; discourse/dialogue; memory/recitation; rhetoric; singing/memory-based pedagogy; contemplation/scholastic; minimal technology.
- Negative keywords present: not explicit; no clear endorsement of project-based or purely experiential-only pedagogy; no evidence of heavy constructivist or student-directed-only frameworks.
- Quantitative note: Positive keywords observed: ~6–7 cues; Negative keywords: 0.
- Why this rating
- The teaching methods align with classical pedagogy: Socratic dialogue, memorization, rhetoric, and a blend of contemplative and rigorous activities, with clearly defined upper-grade discourse. The overall profile is CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The public materials emphasize “faithful faculty” and describe teachers as mentors who live the mission, forming a living curriculum; the presence of a clear “portrait” of teacher and student expectations is indicated (e.g., “Faithful Faculty”; “the living curriculum”).
- Faculty are depicted as catechetically engaged and integrated with the mission: “Every teacher, staff member, and board member is a committed Catholic” and “Teachers and staff as mentors who live their faith with joy and confidence.”
- The site emphasizes governance and a board structure alongside a team of teachers, indicating a collaborative, school-wide commitment to classical aims.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: faithful faculty; living curriculum; mentors; portrait of teacher; Catholic identity across staff; faculty as core.
- Negative keywords present: none evident.
- Quantitative note: Positive keywords observed: 4–5; Negative keywords: 0.
- Why this rating
- The faculty narrative centers on virtue, mentorship, and a shared classical mission, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for this category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school emphasizes partnership with families and parental co-review/formation; public materials highlight parent involvement as part of the school culture (e.g., “a commitment to thrift ... and the deep involvement of parents in the school” as part of keeping tuition affordable).
- Community and governance elements are present (Board of Directors; involvement of families and donors; sharing space with Highlands Latin; campus community).
- The school explicitly frames parents as co-teachers and a crucial part of classical education, with ongoing parent formation and opportunities for involvement (e.g., book studies, gatherings; campus visits). Public materials discuss open-campus access and parental engagement in events.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parents as co-teachers; parent formation; home-school/community integration; open campus; parent involvement.

- Negative keywords present: none evident.
- Quantitative note: Positive keywords observed: 4–5; Negative keywords: 0.
- Why this rating
- The materials consistently position parents as central partners and co-educators in a classical education model, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for this category.

Overall assessment and aggregate classification

- Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL
- The Chesterton Academy of Orlando demonstrates strong alignment with classical education across all six categories, with explicit emphasis on Catholic faith and liturgy, formation-focused goals, Great Books/Liberal Arts curriculum, Socratic pedagogy and rhetoric, a living-Faithful Faculty, and robust parental partnership.
- The keyword analysis (positive keyword indicators vs. negative indicators) consistently favors classical signals in each category, with minimal to no negative signals in the publicly available materials.

What Would Move the Needle - Not applicable here given an overall CLASSICAL rating. If one sought to reinforce CLASSICAL signals further, potential enhancements could include: - Expanding explicit references to a broader range of Great Books within the curriculum, with occasional direct quotes from the texts to demonstrate the depth of Great Conversation. - More explicit articulation of a formal “Scholé” rhythm within the schedule (e.g., explicit Scholé days or dedicated contemplative periods) beyond the general restfulness described in pedagogy.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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